



MATIAS DELACROIX Associated Press



EVGENIY MALOLETKA Associated Press

Factory execs hope for a Trump bump

Manufacturing in the state could rise under him, but his tariffs could get in the way.

BY DON LEE

WASHINGTON — Miriam Mesina de Gutierrez was 19 years old when she got hired at Paulson Manufacturing in Temecula. It was the summer of 2001 and the job was only part time: on an assembly line, applying an anti-fog, anti-scratch coating to face shields for workers in other industries. Never in her wildest dreams could she have imagined where that \$6.75-an-hour job would lead. In 2009, Mesina de Gutierrez became Paulson's human resources manager. Two years later, she moved to international sales. Two more years and she was promoted to vice president of operations. Then, last fall, Mesina de Gutierrez went all the way to the top: president of the 200-employee company that had been headed by a member of the Paulson family for 75 years. "Oh, it was a big deal," [See [Manufacturing](#), A7]



RINGO CHIU For The Times

CHRISTMAS BLESSINGS NEAR AND WIDE

L.A. Archbishop José Gomez, above, greets Men's Central Jail inmates after Christmas Day Mass. Top left, a nun lights a candle while holding a child at Bethlehem's Chapel of St. Catherine. In Ukraine, military chaplain Yuriy holds a service near the front lines.

Putting high rent on public display

Tenants band together on social media to call out listings they see as greedy and excessive.

BY JACK FLEMMING

The Facebook post seemed straightforward enough, offering up a newly built ADU rental in Burbank. Two bedrooms, two bathrooms, 1,000 square feet. A private yard. Finishes "you wouldn't find in any other ADU." The price? \$4,500 per month. "Dam, ya'll need to chill out!! \$4,500 for an ADU??" "Let the rich become richer having the poor paying their mortgage." "The greed is VERY REAL here." "No wonder there are no pictures. Unless the house is gold plated, it's not worth it." People poured in with comments and emoji reactions ranging from laughing to angry. Before long, the post became a digital dogpile, with users tagging others to join in on the fun. The doomed listing became another case of "rent shaming" — a modern, perhaps inevitable, phenomenon that's sprouting up across Facebook housing groups and other platforms as rent continues to soar [See [Rent](#), A5]

A 'durable' plan or flawed fix?

The Biden administration has adopted new rules for operating California's main water delivery systems in the Central Valley. It has endorsed a plan backed by state officials that aims to strike a balance between ensuring protections for imperiled fish species and providing a reliable water supply for farms and cities. Federal and state officials said the new operating rules for the Central Valley Project and the State Water Project that were developed over the last three

U.S. officials approve new rules for water delivery in California

By Ian James

years will bring greater stability to the state's supplies in the face of worsening droughts intensified by climate change. "The updated rules mark a new path forward that will provide more certainty for water users, and fish and wildlife," said Karl Stock, the federal Bureau of Reclamation's regional director, calling it a "durable plan that builds in a great deal of flexibility." The rules took effect last week as the federal bureau [See [Water](#), A5]



BRIAN VAN DER BRUG Los Angeles Times

ENVIRONMENTAL and farming groups both see shortfalls in the new water system framework.

A rocky internal sheriff's probe

Allegations against a whistleblowing lieutenant boomerang for higher-ups.

BY ALENE TCHEKMEDYIAN AND KERI BLAKINGER

When L.A. County Sheriff's Sgt. William Morris was investigating a criminal case against a fellow lieutenant based on a rumor, he kept running into a glaring problem: No one could tell him where the rumor had started. The claim was that Lt. Joseph Garrido had been spotted using a department-issued vehicle to tow his boat to Lake Havasu City in Arizona for a vacation in 2022 — an offense that, if true, could have gotten him disciplined or even prosecuted. It had trickled down from the highest levels of the Sheriff's Department to land in front of Morris at the Internal Criminal Investigations Bureau in May of that year. Morris probed top executives for months about the rumor's origins and received a confounding mix of finger-[See [Investigation](#), A10]

8 deputies are relieved of duty

Beating of trans man and alleged cover-up lead to removals by the sheriff. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Proving women can go distance

Joan Benoit Samuelson's 1984 Olympics marathon win was historic. **SPORTS, B10**

Can't wait for 'Squid Game'?

Anticipation is high for the second season of the wildly popular Netflix drama. **BUSINESS, A6**

Weather

Clouds, periods of sun. L.A. Basin: 67/48. **B6**
For the latest news, go to [latimes.com](#).

Printed with soy inks on partially recycled paper.



7 85944 00200 5



Subscribers get more in the app.

Download now to experience all of The Times.

